



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

TRANSPORTATION & FREIGHT RECOVERY · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Debt Collection Agency for Businesses

Third-party recovery of post-termination contractor balances and aged freight receivables for Trekker Logistics — on pure contingency

Prepared for **Trekker Logistics LLC** · August 2026

Southwest Recovery Services, LLC · Commercial receivables recovery since 2004

Private & confidential

Third-party recovery for the balances your settlement desk has already worked

Prepared for Trekker Logistics LLC — a privately held motor carrier and freight brokerage founded in 1978, headquartered on Bunkum Road in Caseyville, Illinois with operations in Arkansas, Colorado, Iowa and Texas, running Freightliner Cascadia tractors and 53-foot dry vans across the 48 contiguous states and most of Canada. A carrier that contracts owner-operators produces a receivable most businesses never see: settlement deficits that survive the final settlement, fuel and toll advances drawn against future loads, escrow shortfalls, equipment and lease-purchase obligations, damage and insurance chargebacks, and contractual termination fees — all owed by a contractor who has already turned in the truck. On the brokerage side, the exposure runs the other direction: shipper invoices that age past terms while the carrier has already been paid.

Freight already hauled is revenue already earned. A post-termination balance is rarely disputed on the merits — the contractor simply leaves. A driver runs a negative settlement into the final week and hands back the keys. Advances drawn in October are still outstanding in March. A lease-purchase unit comes back with a deficiency balance and damage chargebacks. Escrow gets returned and the deficit stays. Your settlement desk chases these between payroll cycles for as long as it can, and then the account sits.

Southwest Recovery Services is the third-party layer that starts there. We work commercial and business-purpose receivables on **pure contingency since 2004** — nationwide, with FDCPA, Regulation F and FCRA training on every account. No retainer, no minimum, no recovery, no fee.

Two decades of commercial recovery — nationwide

A track record built on high-volume B2B and business-purpose receivables, worked under a documented, compliant process — capacity your settlement and AR desk can add without hiring for it.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY FINANCIAL SERVICES Review

FSR • TOP 10 LIST 2025 Recognition

INTERNATIONAL Business Times

CFO Tech Outlook

insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



 ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

What a carrier's settlement and AR desk asks us — answered directly

The questions that matter when the receivable is a departed contractor's settlement deficit on one side of the house and an aged shipper invoice on the other.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
Do you actually work owner-operator and independent-contractor balances?	Yes, routinely, and on the commercial track. The obligation arises out of a business contract for business purposes, so it is business-purpose debt, not consumer debt — that governs how it is worked. Settlement deficits, fuel and toll advances, escrow shortfalls, equipment and lease-purchase deficiency balances, damage and insurance chargebacks, unreturned equipment, and contractual termination fees are all in scope.
What does third-party recovery cost?	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no monthly minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover. The rate scales with the age, balance size and volume of what you place; we quote it once we see a representative sample of your file.
What has to be in the placement file?	This is what decides the outcome. Per account we need the signed independent-contractor operating agreement and equipment lease, the settlement history showing how the deficit accrued, the advance ledger with authorizations, the escrow ledger and its final accounting, the termination notice and date, the contractor's entity name, and last known contact. Complete files perform. Thin files convert to disputes.
Will 49 CFR Part 376 come up?	Frequently, and you should expect it. Part 376.12 requires every chargeback item and its method of computation to be specified in the lease, and requires a written escrow accounting and return within 45 days of termination. A contractor who wants to contest a deficit reaches for that first. Where your lease is specific and the escrow accounting was issued, these accounts hold up. Where it was not, we will tell you before we work the file rather than after.
What about the brokerage side?	Worked separately, as straight commercial B2B recovery. Unpaid shipper invoices, short-pays, deducted claims and aged trade balances are validated against the rate confirmation, bill of lading and proof of delivery, and pursued against the business. In most carrier-plus-broker operations this is the larger and faster-moving of the two books.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
How is the contractor contacted?	Firm, professional, documented — and never in a way that costs you re-hires or a reputation in a small driver market. Most of these people are still driving somewhere, and drivers talk. Our process is built around preserving your standing in the recruiting pool while still collecting the balance.
How does placement work?	Upload an export from your TMS or settlement system through our secure portal — we map your columns, so nothing gets re-keyed. Outreach begins within 24–48 hours of a documented placement, and you can pull reports and log direct payments yourself at any time.

THE SWRS CLIENT PORTAL

Business-office-ready intake and full visibility, on demand

Every placement is managed through our secure portal — built to take an export from your TMS or settlement system and give your settlement and AR desk live, self-service access throughout recovery.

EXPORT-READY PLACEMENT

Upload a settlement or AR export from your TMS — we map your columns, no re-keying.

SECURE DOCUMENT EXCHANGE

Send operating agreements, equipment leases, settlement statements, advance ledgers and escrow accountings safely inside the portal.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports on demand — a live view of the file instead of a monthly spreadsheet.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a contractor or shipper makes straight to Trekker, so balances stay accurate and no one is contacted twice.

► [Portal Video Tour](#)

SWRS Transportation & Logistics Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's transportation and logistics book, anonymized by sector.

BULK TANK CARRIER

Liquid bulk

\$279K recovered

of ~\$396K placed

70% recovered

SPECIALTY FLEET

Utility trucks

\$32K recovered

of ~\$51K placed

63% recovered

OILFIELD TRUCKING

Roustabout haul

\$43K recovered

of ~\$104K placed

41% recovered

REGIONAL CARRIER

Dry freight trucking

\$30K recovered

of ~\$78K placed

39% recovered

3PL / BROKERAGE

Freight logistics

\$18K recovered

of ~\$51K placed

36% recovered

HOUSEHOLD GOODS

Relocation

\$44K recovered

of ~\$185K placed

24% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

**WHY EARLY PLACEMENT
MATTERS**

A contractor balance is most collectible while the driver is still findable

Post-termination balances decay faster than most because the person owing the money has already left and is usually driving for someone else. Every month after termination, phone numbers change, the entity dissolves, and the balance drifts toward write-off.

THE AGE CURVE

Balances placed within 90–120 days of the final settlement recover materially better than balances that sit a year past termination.

THE STANDING RULE

A fixed placement policy beats case-by-case decisions, and on contingency there is no cost to placing.

Recovery figures vary by portfolio, documentation quality and lease terms; SWRS gives an honest, age-based read on a representative sample before any accounts are worked.

We speak your ledger

A contractor fleet plus a brokerage desk produces two distinct recovery profiles under one roof. Our playbook is built for both.



Settlement deficits after termination

Negative final settlements and unrecovered advances owed by a contractor who has already turned in the truck — worked from your operating agreement and settlement history.



Equipment & lease-purchase balances

Deficiency balances, damage and repair chargebacks, and unreturned equipment — the category that draws the most pushback, and the one where lease specificity decides the outcome.



Contractors who stop answering

Skip tracing the individual and the entity across state lines after a termination, a move, or a dissolved LLC — so the balance stays attached to the obligor.



Brokerage receivables, worked separately

Aged shipper invoices, short-pays and deducted claims, validated against the rate confirmation, BOL and POD and pursued as straight commercial B2B recovery.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention on aged balances and fewer disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



Capabilities overview

Prepared for Trekker · PDF

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The Aktos Advantage

AI collections platform · PDF

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The Experian Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

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The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

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Collections Done Right

Contact strategy & compliance · PDF

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Credit-Reporting Advantage

A recovery lever · PDF

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Let's turn your written-off contractor balances back into cash.

A 30-minute call to walk a representative sample of Trekker's terminated-contractor balances and aged brokerage invoices, confirm what is realistically collectible against your operating agreement, and put a contingency rate against it.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

Steven Dietz

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12 offices across 7 states · nationwide recovery. Private & confidential — prepared for Trekker Logistics LLC. FDCPA / CFPB / FCRA compliant · ACA International member.